Introduction

We use electricity in our day to day life. Have we ever wondered from where do we get this electricity? How does this electricity work? Can we imagine a day without electricity? If you ask your grandfather, you can come to know a period without electricity. They used oil lamps for light, cooked on fires of wood or coal. By the advent of electricity, our day to day works are made easy and the world is on our hands. What are the appliances those work on electricity? What are the materials those allow electricity to flow through? What are electric circuits? What are electric cells and batteries? Come on, let us descend into this lesson to know more about electricity.

Activity 1:

List out the electrical appliances used in your home.

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2.1 Sources of Electricity

Selvan and Selvi are twins. They are studying in sixth standard. They visited their grandparent's village during summer vacation. At 6 O'clock in the evening Selvan's Grandfather switched on the light. The whole house was illuminated. Seeing this Selvan asked his grandfather "How do we get light by switching on the switch?" So, his grandfather took him to the nearest electricity board and enquired about the electricity.

Let us look in to the conversation given below.

Selvan: Sir, How do the electric bulb lighten up when we switch on the switch?

Engineer: Due to electricity.

Selvan: Oh! From where do we get this electricity?

Engineer: We get electricity from *thermal power, hydel power, tidal power, wind power, solar power* etc., as sources of electricity.

Selvan: Sir! Are these plants exist everywhere?

Engineer: No, these plants are constructed depending upon the natural resources available at that particular place. For example, we have thermal power plant in Neyveli, Tamilnadu as lignite is available there.

Selvan: Yes, I have seen wind mills near the hills of Tirunelveli District which has potential wind resource. Thank you sir, for your valuable information.

Grandfather: (while walking back to home) Do you think we get electricity only from the above mentioned sources.

Selvan: (while entering into the home, noticing the clock on the wall) Grandpa! look at that wall clock, How does it work?.

Grandfather: It needs electrical energy to work. Apart from the above mentioned sources, we get electricity from cells, and batteries.

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